SREENIDHI MODEL UNITED NATIONS

SMUN 2026 | COMMITTEE BACKGROUND GUIDE

INDIAN PARLIAMENTARY COMMITTEE

LOK SABHA

House of the People

COMMITTEE AGENDA

Deliberation on the Review and Reform of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, with Special Emphasis on Equitable Access, Quality of Education, and Implementation Challenges Across India

Equity • Learning • Parliamentary Accountability

Message from the Secretariat

Dear Members,

Welcome to Sreenidhi Model United Nations 2026. The Secretariat is pleased to welcome you to Lok Sabha, where the deliberations will concern the review and reform of the National Education Policy 2020, with special emphasis on equitable access, educational quality and implementation challenges across India.

Education is both a constitutional and a developmental concern. The policies considered in this House affect how children learn, how teachers are supported, how institutions are financed and how opportunities are shared across communities and States. The debate therefore calls for careful attention to evidence, constitutional responsibilities and the realities of implementation.

This Background Guide introduces Lok Sabha and the agenda, explains the evolution and main features of NEP 2020, and examines competing considerations concerning inclusion, learning outcomes, financing, federal coordination and institutional capacity. It is a foundation for independent research, not a predetermined position on the merits of the policy.

Members are encouraged to study the available parliamentary and government materials, distinguish policy targets from achieved outcomes and develop practical proposals capable of scrutiny. The strength of a parliamentary argument rests on its evidence, clarity, democratic accountability and consideration of the communities affected.

We look forward to principled, informed and constructive deliberations.

Warm regards,
The Secretariat
Sreenidhi Model United Nations 2026

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A parliamentary guide to education reform, federal cooperation and equitable learning opportunities.

01 Introduction to the Committee

Lok Sabha, the House of the People, is the directly elected chamber of the Parliament of India. Along with Rajya Sabha and the President, it forms part of the constitutional Parliament and exercises legislative, deliberative and oversight functions. Its elected representatives debate national questions, scrutinise the actions of the executive, examine proposed laws and participate in decisions concerning public expenditure.

Lok Sabha is particularly significant to the present agenda because education is closely connected with constitutional commitments, equality of opportunity and public investment. Questions to Ministers, debates, committee examinations and consideration of demands for grants provide parliamentary avenues for assessing whether national policy is being translated into effective results. The House also serves as a forum in which different States, constituencies and political perspectives can be heard.

Its authority must be understood in the framework of the Constitution. Education principally falls under Entry 25 of the Concurrent List, subject to specified entries concerning standards and other matters in the Union List. Consequently, responsibility for education is shared and implementation commonly depends on cooperation between the Union and the States. Legislative, executive and institutional responsibilities must not be treated as interchangeable.

For the purposes of this Model Parliament, delegates should speak from the assigned role and its documented political or institutional position, while grounding their arguments in constitutional principles, credible statistics and practical policy analysis. The debate is not simply about endorsing or rejecting NEP 2020, but about assessing its goals, achievements, limitations and possible improvements.

02 Introduction to the Agenda

The agenda, *Deliberation on the Review and Reform of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, with Special Emphasis on Equitable Access, Quality of Education, and Implementation Challenges Across India*, invites the House to examine whether the policy's vision has been matched by appropriate implementation arrangements, accessible institutions and measurable improvements in educational outcomes. It calls for both a review of the substantive design of NEP 2020 and a constructive assessment of reforms that may be necessary to deliver its objectives.

Adopted in 2020, the policy outlines changes in school, higher, vocational and adult education. Its central ambitions include stronger foundational learning, curricular flexibility, multilingualism, broader participation, improved teacher preparation, a more multidisciplinary higher-education system and greater attention to inclusion and institutional accountability. These ambitions must be examined in the context of India's geographic, linguistic, socio-economic and administrative diversity.

Equitable access concerns whether every learner can enter and remain in education with meaningful support. Quality concerns what students learn, the conditions under which they learn and the value of their qualifications. Implementation concerns the budgets, institutions, administrative responsibilities, professional capacity and timelines required to transform policy text into classroom practice.

The task before members is to deliberate upon feasible reforms supported by evidence. Particular attention should be paid to national and State-level differences, the policy's relationship with existing laws, and the distinction between announced programmes, expenditure, outputs and demonstrated outcomes.

03 Explanation of the Agenda

3.1 Historical Context: From Earlier Education Policies to NEP 2020

India's modern education-policy framework has developed through successive national efforts to broaden access while improving learning outcomes. The National Policy on Education of 1968 and the National Policy on Education of 1986, modified in 1992, addressed national priorities including educational opportunity, social justice, curriculum and institutional development. Over time, the expansion of schooling and higher education prompted renewed questions concerning quality, inclusion, skills and institutional governance.

Constitutional developments shaped this trajectory. Article 21A recognises free and compulsory education for children aged six to fourteen, while the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 provides a statutory framework for elementary education. Education is principally addressed under the Concurrent List, requiring cooperation between Union and State governments. The National Education Policy 2020, announced on 29 July 2020, proposed a comprehensive redesign of the education system, extending from early childhood through higher and adult education.

3.2 Understanding the Policy: Vision, Structure and Core Reforms

NEP 2020 seeks to advance access, equity, quality, affordability and accountability. In school education, it proposes a 5+3+3+4 curricular and pedagogical structure covering the foundational, preparatory, middle and secondary stages, with greater recognition of early childhood care and education. Foundational literacy and numeracy, experiential learning, curricular flexibility, vocational exposure and changes in assessment are major themes.

The policy encourages instruction in the home, mother, local or regional language wherever possible, particularly in the early grades; implementation necessarily raises questions about teacher preparation, learning materials, parental choice and linguistic diversity. For higher education, its proposals include multidisciplinary institutions, more flexible academic pathways, credit mobility, research capacity and reforms to regulation and governance. These are policy objectives whose implementation must be evaluated separately from their announcement.

3.3 Equitable Access: Geography, Gender and Socio-Economic Disadvantage

Access to education cannot be assessed solely through the availability of a school or university. Geographic distance, transport, affordability, safety, disability access, language, digital connectivity and household circumstances can affect enrolment, attendance, retention and completion. The policy places particular emphasis on socio-economically disadvantaged groups, including learners confronting multiple and overlapping barriers.

Members should assess whether new educational opportunities are reaching rural and remote communities, Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, girls, children with disabilities, migrant families and first-generation learners. Effective legislative proposals may address scholarships, hostels, transport, safe sanitation, assistive technology, accessible materials and targeted academic support, with clear eligibility standards and measurable outcomes.

3.4 Quality of Education: Learning Outcomes, Teachers and Assessment

Education quality is determined not merely by years of attendance but by what learners understand and can do. The ability to read with comprehension, demonstrate numeracy, reason critically and apply knowledge is foundational to later learning. NEP 2020 identifies foundational literacy and numeracy as a priority and envisages curricular and assessment changes designed to support meaningful learning rather than rote memorisation.

Teacher recruitment, preparation, deployment, professional development and working conditions are essential to implementation. Members should examine the distribution of qualified teachers across regions and subjects, multi-grade classrooms, institutional leadership, learning materials and the reliability of assessments. Improvements in reported pupil–teacher ratios are relevant but do not by themselves establish uniform classroom quality or subject-wise adequacy.

3.5 Implementation and Federal Coordination

The shift from policy design to nationwide practice depends upon a wide set of institutions: the Union Ministry of Education, State education departments, school boards, universities, regulators, local authorities and educational institutions. Education's constitutional allocation means that uniform policy aspirations operate alongside diverse State priorities, administrative capabilities and curricula.

Implementation may therefore advance at different speeds. Parliamentary examination should distinguish between a centrally announced measure, a State-level adoption decision, budgetary allocation, institutional rollout and demonstrated student outcomes. Consultation, transparent timelines, appropriate State flexibility and shared reporting standards can assist coordination without obscuring the respective constitutional responsibilities of different authorities.

3.6 Financing, Infrastructure and Institutional Capacity

NEP 2020 reiterates an aspiration for public investment in education to reach 6 per cent of gross domestic product. This is a policy objective rather than an automatically binding annual appropriation. Expenditure decisions must also address competing public needs, the allocation of funds between education levels, and the capabilities of institutions tasked with delivering reforms.

Parliamentary deliberation should explore capital expenditure, recurring teacher and staff costs, libraries, laboratories, early childhood facilities, disability access and maintenance. Members may

consider outcome-based reporting and independent evaluation, while avoiding the assumption that increased expenditure alone guarantees better learning. Any proposal should identify financing responsibility, phasing, administrative feasibility and safeguards against widening regional disparities.

3.7 Digital Education, Technology and Language

Digital infrastructure can widen access to materials, teacher training and flexible learning, but it may also deepen inequalities when households lack affordable devices, power, connectivity or accessible content. Educational platforms must be evaluated for learning effectiveness, data protection, accessibility and their capacity to support, rather than displace, classroom instruction.

India's linguistic diversity presents an additional implementation question. The production of quality textbooks, teacher resources and assessments in multiple languages demands sustained capacity. Delegates should consider how multilingual education can promote comprehension and inclusion while preserving mobility between different school systems, access to higher education and the freedom of learners to acquire additional languages.

3.8 Higher Education, Employability and Research

NEP 2020 sets an objective of raising the gross enrolment ratio in higher education to 50 per cent by 2035. The Ministry of Education's July 2026 publication of AISHE reports states that this ratio reached 30 per cent in 2023–24. The latter is an observed historical survey measure, not the policy's target. Such distinctions are essential when evaluating progress.

Multidisciplinary curricula, academic credit frameworks, institutional autonomy, vocational pathways and the relationship between degrees and employment warrant careful analysis. Expansion must also be assessed in terms of teaching quality, affordability, scholarships, research opportunities, accreditation and equitable participation. Members should scrutinise both access to institutions and the meaningful value of qualifications earned.

3.9 Current Challenges and Evidence of Progress

Government reporting in 2026 identifies a range of implementation initiatives, including PM SHRI schools, Samagra Shiksha, NIPUN Bharat, new curriculum frameworks, teacher-training programmes, academic credit frameworks and digital learning systems. The UDISE+ 2025–26 release reports approximately 1.027 crore teachers in schools and improvements in several aggregate infrastructure indicators. These data help establish the scale of the system and particular reported changes; they do not resolve all questions about local disparities and learning quality.

Implementation challenges remain suitable for evidence-based parliamentary scrutiny: children who discontinue schooling, accessibility barriers, uneven digital infrastructure, teacher vacancies in specific locations, institutional financing, language-related transition difficulties and the varying capacity of

States and educational institutions. Members should compare the relevant reporting years and definitions before drawing conclusions from national averages.

3.10 Current Government Responses and Areas for Reform

Current approaches include school-upgradation programmes, learning-recovery and foundational-skills initiatives, curriculum revision, integrated teacher development, digital platforms and reforms to academic credits and higher-education pathways. The appropriate parliamentary question is not merely whether an initiative exists, but how its coverage, costs, results and unintended consequences are measured.

Potential areas for discussion include a phased implementation framework negotiated with States, targeted assistance for disadvantaged districts, strengthened teacher-development systems, transparent education dashboards, disability-inclusive infrastructure and stronger review of learning outcomes. Proposals should distinguish executive implementation from legislation, regulatory changes and the budgetary decisions that Parliament may lawfully pursue.

3.11 Parliamentary Deliberation and Accountability

Lok Sabha is central to democratic scrutiny of education policy through debates, questions to Ministers, parliamentary committees, legislation within Parliament's competence and financial oversight. A national education policy is not itself an Act of Parliament: some reforms may be pursued administratively, whereas others may require statutes, delegated legislation, State action or institutional decisions.

For this simulated parliamentary sitting, members should critically evaluate the policy without presuming that every reform is uniformly beneficial or uniformly defective. Arguments should identify a clear issue, supporting evidence, relevant Union–State responsibilities, a legally and financially feasible response, and a means of monitoring implementation. Members are encouraged to distinguish positions taken in debate from established facts and to use parliamentary procedure constructively.

04 Reference Links and Resources

The following authoritative policy texts, government reports and legislative research materials provide a starting point for research. Each title is a clickable link. Members should examine the publication date, underlying methodology and jurisdictional relevance before citing any statistic or policy claim.

01. **National Education Policy 2020 — Ministry of Education**

Primary policy text: commitments, proposed reforms, implementation framework and stated objectives.

02. **Ministry of Education — NEP 2020 Initiatives**

Official initiatives and educational programmes associated with implementation.

03. **Ministry of Education — Parliamentary Reply (10 August 2026)**

Recent government account of school and higher-education initiatives and reforms.

04. **UDISE+ 2025–26 School Education Report — PIB**

Official school-system indicators on staffing, access, infrastructure and transition.

05. **All India Survey on Higher Education 2022–23 and 2023–24**

Reported higher-education enrolment and gross enrolment ratios, published July 2026.

06. **AISHE Official Report Library**

Survey documents, methods and original higher-education statistical reports.

07. **Supreme Court of India — Constitution**

Constitutional framework for legislative competence and Union–State relations.

08. **PRS Legislative Research — NEP 2020 Summary**

Independent policy summary and discussion of institutional and financing proposals.

09. **National Education Policy 2020 Announcement — PIB**

Official announcement and statement of school and higher-education targets.

10. **Ministry of Education — Annual Report 2024–25**

Departmental reporting on programmes, initiatives, statistics and education administration.

05 Questions to Consider

The following questions are intended to guide parliamentary research, deliberation and the formulation of specific, workable recommendations. Members should consider constitutional competence, implementation responsibilities and supporting evidence.

01. Which elements of NEP 2020 have been implemented in the Member's State or constituency, and what verifiable indicators demonstrate progress or delay?

02. How should Parliament evaluate the success of NEP 2020: enrolment, retention, learning outcomes, equity, employability, or a combination of independently reported measures?

03. What institutional or financial barriers prevent equal educational access for rural, tribal, low-income, migrant and other disadvantaged learners?

04. How can educational inclusion for children with disabilities be improved through accessible infrastructure, trained staff and appropriate learning materials?

05. What reforms are most urgent to strengthen foundational literacy and numeracy, and how should their effectiveness be assessed?

06. How can teacher recruitment, deployment, training and retention be improved while recognising the responsibilities of State governments?

07. What practical challenges arise in implementing mother-tongue or regional-language instruction, particularly in multilingual and mobile populations?

08. How can curricular flexibility and vocational education be expanded without creating unequal educational pathways or reducing academic rigour?

09. What safeguards are required to ensure that educational technology narrows, rather than deepens, the digital divide?

10. How should the Union and State governments coordinate NEP implementation while respecting constitutional federalism and legitimate local priorities?

11. What funding model could support infrastructure, teachers and inclusion while maintaining fiscal sustainability and public accountability?

12. How should higher education balance enrolment expansion, affordability, institutional autonomy, research quality and employment outcomes?

13. What legislative measures, parliamentary oversight mechanisms or committee reviews would most effectively address implementation gaps?

14. How can reliable national and State-level educational statistics be used to set realistic milestones and assess whether reforms benefit students?

15. Which specific provisions of NEP 2020 should be retained, revised or reconsidered, and what evidence justifies each recommendation?